

Anti-Bullying Week 2026 Classroom Pack

Assembly outlines, four age-banded lesson plans, Odd Socks Day activity, parent template and staff briefing.

DRAFT FOR PROFESSIONAL REVIEW

Use this resource alongside your school's current policy, safeguarding procedures and official regional guidance. Do not use it to record pupil names or confidential case details.

How to use this pack

Choose activities that fit your pupils' age, communication needs and school context. Brief staff on the reporting route before any pupil-facing activity.

- [] Name the trusted adults pupils can approach before the session begins.
- [] Avoid asking pupils to disclose personal experiences in front of a group.
- [] Offer a private follow-up route after every activity.
- [] Follow the school's safeguarding procedure if a concern is raised.
- [] Adapt examples and language for accessibility, age and local context.

Primary assembly outline

Suggested length: 10-15 minutes. Aim: help pupils recognise kind, unkind and repeated harmful behaviour, and know how to seek help.

Opening

Welcome pupils and explain that the session is about helping everyone feel safe, included and able to ask for help. Make clear that nobody will be asked to share a personal story.

Three prompts

- [] What can kindness look like in a classroom or playground?
- [] What might make it difficult for someone to speak up?
- [] Which trusted adults can pupils approach in this school?

Closing script

If something is happening to you or someone else, you do not have to solve it alone. Tell a trusted adult. If the first conversation does not help, keep asking until an adult listens and supports you.

Staff follow-up

Repeat the school's reporting route and tell pupils how to ask for a private conversation after the assembly.

Post-primary assembly outline

Suggested length: 15-20 minutes. Aim: explore silence, peer pressure, online escalation and safe bystander choices.

Opening

Frame the session around choices: posting, forwarding, reacting, saving evidence privately, leaving a chat, checking in with someone and asking an adult for help.

Scenario

A screenshot from a private conversation is shared in a year-group chat. Some pupils add laughing reactions, others forward it, and several stay silent because they do not want attention turned on them.

Discussion prompts

- [] Which actions increase the harm, even if the pupil did not create the original post?
- [] What could a bystander do without confronting the group publicly?
- [] What information should be kept private and shown to a trusted adult?
- [] What is the school's reporting route for an online concern?

Closing

Reinforce that safe help-seeking is not the same as public confrontation, and that serious threats, coercion or image-based abuse require the school's safeguarding route.

KS1 lesson: kindness, inclusion and trusted adults

Suggested length: 20-30 minutes

Activities

- [] Sort simple fictional examples into kind, unkind and needs-an-adult-support.
- [] Draw or name the trusted adults and safe spaces available in school.
- [] Practise one sentence a pupil could use to ask for help.

Check for understanding

Each pupil can identify at least one trusted adult and one help-seeking phrase.

Private follow-up

End by repeating the school's trusted-adult and safeguarding routes. Do not ask for public disclosure.

KS2 lesson: patterns, power and bystander choices

Suggested length: 30-40 minutes

Activities

- [] Compare one-off conflict with a repeated pattern of harmful behaviour without labelling real pupils.
- [] Use scenario cards to choose safe bystander actions.
- [] Map the school's private reporting route.

Check for understanding

Pupils can describe two safe ways to support a peer and explain when an adult is needed.

Private follow-up

End by repeating the school's trusted-adult and safeguarding routes. Do not ask for public disclosure.

KS3 lesson: group chats and breaking the silence safely

Suggested length: 40-50 minutes

Activities

- [] Discuss a fictional group-chat scenario.
- [] Identify how forwarding, reacting and silence can affect harm.
- [] Create a step-by-step safe response: pause, keep relevant information private, tell a trusted adult and avoid public escalation.

Check for understanding

Pupils can identify a safe reporting route and distinguish support from retaliation.

Private follow-up

End by repeating the school's trusted-adult and safeguarding routes. Do not ask for public disclosure.

KS4 lesson: peer norms, prejudice and responsible action

Suggested length: 45-60 minutes

Activities

- [] Explore how status, group norms and fear of becoming a target can shape bystander behaviour.
- [] Review fictional examples of prejudice-based and online bullying.
- [] Draft a practical year-group commitment that includes private reporting and follow-up.

Check for understanding

Pupils can evaluate response options and identify actions that reduce rather than amplify harm.

Private follow-up

End by repeating the school's trusted-adult and safeguarding routes. Do not ask for public disclosure.

Odd Socks Day activity

Use the visible activity to open a conversation about difference and belonging without suggesting that socks alone prevent bullying.

- [] Invite pupils to wear odd socks if they wish; provide a no-cost classroom alternative.
- [] Ask groups to create one practical action that helps someone feel included.
- [] Display the school's reporting route beside campaign artwork.
- [] Collect anonymous campaign feedback without inviting incident details.

Parent and carer newsletter template

Subject: Anti-Bullying Week 2026 at [School name]

This week pupils will take part in age-appropriate activities about respectful behaviour, safe bystander choices and asking for help. The work supports our existing anti-bullying and safeguarding procedures.

Families can help by listening calmly, encouraging children to speak to a trusted adult and using the school's private reporting route if a concern arises. Please avoid sharing details about pupils on social media.

Our school contact route is: [insert named role, email or monitored form]. Our policy is available at: [insert link].

If you have an urgent safeguarding concern, follow the school's safeguarding procedure. If someone is in immediate danger, call 999 or 112.

Five-minute staff briefing

- [] Who owns the campaign week and daily messages?
- [] Which exact words will staff use for reporting and follow-up?
- [] Where will concerns be recorded and who reviews them?
- [] What private follow-up is available after assemblies or lessons?
- [] When does a concern move into the safeguarding process?
- [] How will pupil and parent feedback shape follow-up after the week?

Official sources

Anti-Bullying Alliance - Anti-Bullying Week 2026: <https://anti-bullyingalliance.org.uk/anti-bullying-week-2026>

Education Authority NI - Addressing Bullying in Schools:

<https://www.eani.org.uk/schools/policies-and-guidance/other-policies-and-procedures/addressing-bullying-in-schools-act-0>

Department of Education and Youth - Bi Cinealta procedures: <https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/policy-information/b%C3%AD-cine%C3%A1lta-procedures-to-prevent-and-address-bullying-behaviour-for-primary-and-post-primary-schools/>

Childline UK: <https://www.childline.org.uk/get-support/>

Childline Ireland: <https://www.childline.ie/topics/bullying-and-abuse>

Review record

[] Professional reviewer and role:

[] Review date:

[] Approved version number:

[] Next scheduled review: